

1947, February 13.

The following is a faithful transcription of a carbon copy of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST FELIX CAPUCHIN PRIARY
Huntington, Indiana
February 13th 1947.

Mrs. Irene O'Donnell
Miami Beach, Florida

Dear Mrs. O'Donnell:

God bless you and yours. I hope you keep well. Many thanks for your charitable favor of February 7th, duly received and noted. Please pardon tardiness of acknowledgement, etc. I do hope you find things at least a little more promising in Detroit when you return thither, than they generally have been these many moons. And of course that you will be feeling better, and more able to bear up under the pressure that has certainly not added to your temporal peace.

And after all, dear Mrs. O'Donnell; I do congratulate you on the attitude and the conclusion that just that pressure, perhaps more than any thing else - aside from the grace of God - has been the means of bringing you to; viz, "... that probably I am the one will have to change and not notice every trifle.... quarling only makes matters worse."

How fortunate you are to have finally arrived at such a conclusion - by the grace of God and your own experience. Indeed, that looks to me like a good beginning of a real conversion. And, just incidently, the very first adage I remember wondering at, being about four at the time and not fully understanding its meaning, was: "WELL BEGUN, IS HALF DONE."

Sometimes, in fact very often, as we see in the lives of the saints, it is only after many a battle and a long struggle with ourselves and against the injustices of the world that we learn to appreciate, as otherwise we probably never would learn, the sweetness that patient suffering unfailingly brings in the end, - often long before the end. So that, as the present Monsignor E'd F. Casey wrote after quite a decade of youthful struggles he could write, on his final start in the seminary for the holy Priest-hood - the great goal of his heart: